

NTANDOMODS ICT DIPLOMA

MONTH 5

Email & Internet

Gmail, Web Browsing, Online Safety & Communication

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Introduction

The internet connects the world. Email is the standard way businesses communicate. If you cannot use email and browse the internet safely, you will struggle in any modern workplace.

This month covers everything you need: creating and managing email accounts, writing professional emails, using the internet for research, and staying safe online.

Learning Outcomes

- Create and manage a Gmail account
- Compose, send, reply, and forward emails professionally
- Attach files to emails
- Organise emails with labels, folders, and search
- Use a web browser to search for information
- Identify safe and unsafe websites
- Understand online scams and how to avoid them
- Download files safely from the internet

Unit 1: Email Basics with Gmail

1.1 What is Email?

Email (electronic mail) is a way to send messages, files, and documents over the internet. It is free, instant, and used by every business. Your email address is like your professional ID online.

1.2 Creating a Gmail Account

1. Open a web browser (Google Chrome is recommended)
2. Go to gmail.com
3. Click 'Create account'
4. Enter your first name and last name
5. Choose a username (this becomes your email address: yourname@gmail.com)
6. Create a strong password (at least 8 characters, mix of letters, numbers, and symbols)
7. Add a recovery phone number for security
8. Agree to the terms and click Create

Choosing a Professional Email Address

Your email address represents you to employers and businesses. Choose wisely.

GOOD (Professional)	BAD (Unprofessional)
tendai.moyo@gmail.com	coolguy2005@gmail.com
t.ncube.zw@gmail.com	babygirl_cute@gmail.com
ntando.business@gmail.com	420blazeit@gmail.com

1.3 The Gmail Interface

Section	What it Does
Inbox	Where new emails arrive
Compose	Button to write a new email
Sent	Emails you have sent
Drafts	Emails you started but have not sent yet
Spam	

	Junk email - check occasionally for misplaced real emails
Trash	Deleted emails (automatically emptied after 30 days)
Search bar	Find any email by keyword, sender, or date

Unit 2: Writing Professional Emails

2.1 Parts of an Email

Field	Explanation
To	The recipient's email address
CC	Carbon Copy - send a copy to others who should see it
BCC	Blind Carbon Copy - recipients cannot see each other's addresses
Subject	Brief description of what the email is about (NEVER leave empty)
Body	The main message
Attachment	Files attached (documents, photos, etc.)
Signature	Your name and contact details at the bottom

2.2 Email Etiquette Rules

1. Always include a clear subject line
2. Start with a greeting: Dear Mr/Mrs/Ms [Name] or Good morning/afternoon
3. State your purpose in the first sentence
4. Keep emails short and to the point
5. Use proper English - no text speak (no 'u' instead of 'you', no 'lol')
6. End with a professional closing: Kind regards / Best regards / Yours sincerely
7. Include your full name, phone number, and position in your signature
8. Proofread before sending - you cannot unsend an email

9. Reply within 24 hours (even if just to say you will respond fully later)
10. Never send emails when angry - write it, save as draft, review the next day

2.3 Attaching Files

1. Click Compose to start a new email
2. Click the paperclip icon at the bottom of the compose window
3. Select the file from your computer
4. Wait for the file to upload (you will see a progress bar)
5. Then send the email as normal

Maximum attachment size in Gmail: 25 MB. For larger files, use Google Drive.

2.4 Replying and Forwarding

- Reply: sends your response back to the person who emailed you
- Reply All: sends your response to everyone in the email chain (use carefully!)
- Forward: sends the email to a different person with your comment

WARNING: Be very careful with Reply All. If 50 people are on the email, all 50 will see your reply.

Unit 3: Internet Browsing

3.1 What is the Internet?

The internet is a global network that connects computers around the world. The World Wide Web (WWW) is the system of websites and pages you can access using a web browser.

3.2 Web Browsers

A web browser is the programme you use to access websites. The most common browsers are:

- Google Chrome (most popular, recommended)

- Mozilla Firefox
- Microsoft Edge
- Safari (Apple devices only)

3.3 Using the Address Bar

The address bar is at the top of the browser. You can type a website address (URL) directly, like www.google.com, or type a search query.

Understanding URLs

- <https://> means the site is secure (the 's' stands for secure)
- <http://> means the site is NOT secure - never enter passwords on http sites
- [.co.zw](http://www.co.zw) is a Zimbabwean website
- [.com](http://www.com) is a commercial website (international)
- [.gov.zw](http://www.gov.zw) is a Zimbabwe government website
- [.org](http://www.org) is a non-profit organisation

3.4 Searching with Google

1. Open Google Chrome
2. Go to google.com (or type your search in the address bar)
3. Type what you are looking for in clear, simple words
4. Press Enter
5. Read the results - the first few are usually the most relevant

Search Tips

- Be specific: 'ICT courses Harare 2026' is better than 'courses'
- Use quotes for exact phrases: "NtandoMods till operating course"
- Add 'Zimbabwe' or 'Harare' if you want local results

Unit 4: Online Safety

4.1 Common Online Threats in Zimbabwe

Threat	How it Works	How to Avoid
Phishing	Fake emails pretending to be your bank or EcoCash	Never click links in suspicious emails. Banks will never ask for your PIN via email
Scam websites	Sites that look real but steal your information	Check for https:// and verify the URL carefully
Fake job offers	'Send \$50 registration fee to get a \$2000/month job'	Legitimate jobs never ask you to pay to apply
WhatsApp scams	'Forward this to 10 people to win a prize'	If it sounds too good to be true, it is
Malware	Viruses downloaded from unsafe websites	Only download from trusted sites. Never open suspicious email attachments

4.2 Password Safety

1. Use at least 8 characters with uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and symbols
2. Never use your name, birthday, or '123456' as a password
3. Use a different password for each account
4. Never share your passwords with anyone - not even friends
5. Change passwords every 3-6 months
6. Enable 2-Step Verification on Gmail (Settings > Security)

4.3 Safe Downloading

- Only download from official websites (e.g. microsoft.com for Office)
- Never download cracked or pirated software - it usually contains viruses
- If a website asks you to download something unexpected, close the tab immediately

- Keep your antivirus updated

Month 5 Assessment

Theory (30 marks)

1. What is the difference between CC and BCC? When would you use each? (6 marks)
2. List 5 rules of professional email etiquette. (10 marks)
3. What does https:// mean and why is it important? (4 marks)
4. Name 3 common online scams in Zimbabwe and how to avoid them. (6 marks)
5. What makes a strong password? Give an example. (4 marks)

Practical (70 marks)

1. Create a Gmail account with a professional email address. Set up a signature with your name, phone number, and 'NtandoMods ICT Student'. (15 marks)
2. Send a professional email to your trainer with: proper subject line, greeting, body paragraph asking about job opportunities, closing, and signature. Attach your CV from Month 2. (20 marks)
3. Reply to an email from your trainer. Forward that reply to a classmate with a note. (10 marks)
4. Use Google to research and write a one-page summary about a topic assigned by your trainer. Include at least 3 sources. (15 marks)
5. Identify 3 phishing emails from samples provided by your trainer. Explain what makes each one suspicious. (10 marks)

Pass Mark: 60%